



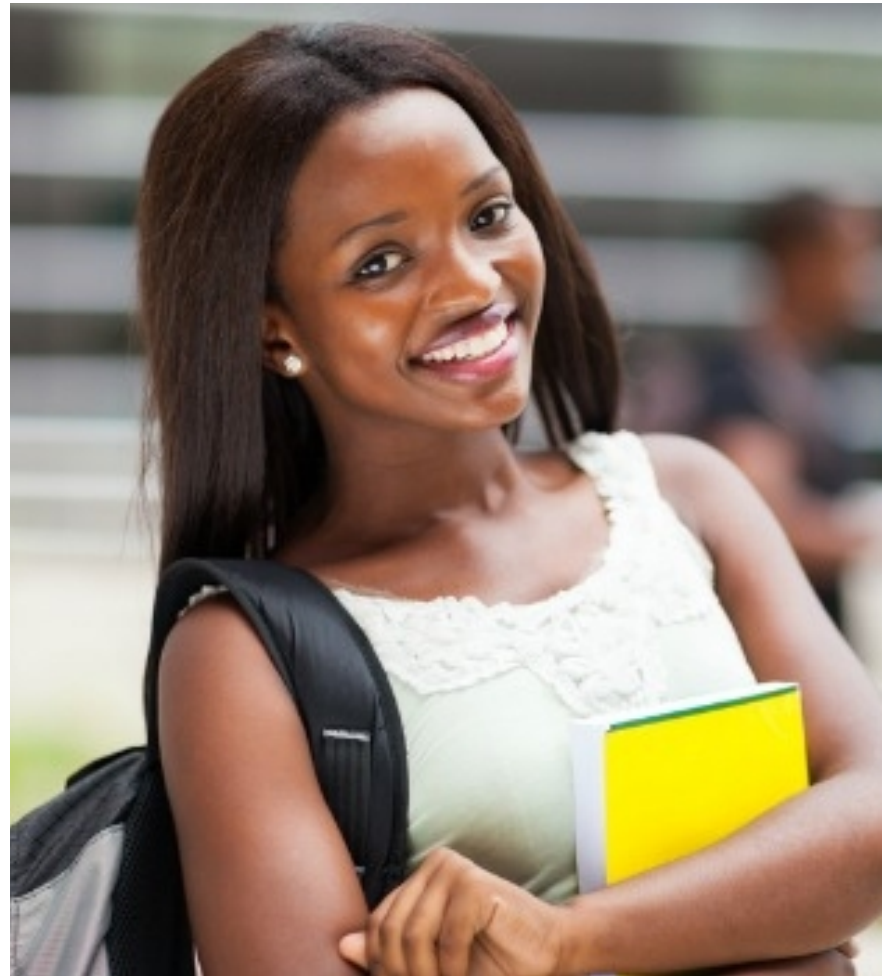
Creating the vision: Building college expectations for students with disabilities

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The ideal college student

- Good grades
 - Honor and AP Courses
 - Extracurricular activities
 - Student government
 - Athletics
-
- Looking to:
 - Attend a 4 year college
 - Live on campus
 - Enjoy college life



MANY COLLEGE STUDENTS ARE OLDER THAN 25, AND MOST ARE BALANCING SCHOOL WITH WORK AND FAMILIES.

38% OF UNDER-GRADUATES ARE OLDER THAN 25



58% WORK WHILE ENROLLED IN COLLEGE



26% ARE RAISING CHILDREN



THINK YOU KNOW THE FACTS? **TODAY'S COLLEGE STUDENTS ARE...**

BALANCING MULTIPLE RESPONSIBILITIES



**THREE-QUARTERS
OF COLLEGE STUDENTS**
COMMUTE TO CLASS WHILE JUGGLING PARENTING,
WORKING AND BOTH.

40 PERCENT
ATTEND SCHOOL ONLY
PART-TIME.



STUDENTS WORK ON AVERAGE
**19 HOURS
PER WEEK**



ABOUT
40 PERCENT
OF COMMUNITY-COLLEGE STUDENTS
WORK 20 OR MORE HOURS
PER WEEK.

Lumina Foundation

<https://www.luminafoundation.org/todays-student-citations>



LESS LIKELY TO GRADUATE



STUDENTS WITH ADDITIONAL FINANCIAL,
WORK AND FAMILY OBLIGATIONS ARE
TWICE AS LIKELY
TO DROP OUT OF SCHOOL
IN THEIR FIRST YEAR AS STUDENTS
FRESH OUT OF HIGH SCHOOL –
38 PERCENT COMPARED TO 16 PERCENT.



NO MORE THAN
A QUARTER OF
PART-TIME STUDENTS
MAKE IT TO GRADUATION, EVEN WHEN
GIVEN TWICE AS LONG TO COMPLETE.



OLDER AND MORE RACIALLY DIVERSE



38 PERCENT
OF ALL TODAY'S UNDERGRADUATES
ARE OLDER THAN 25.

THE VISION THAT MOST OF US HAVE OF
COLLEGE STUDENTS – 18- TO 21-YEAR-OLDS
WHO ATTEND SCHOOL FULL-TIME – ONLY
MAKE UP ABOUT A THIRD OF THE
COLLEGE POPULATION.



ENROLLMENT AMONG
HISPANIC STUDENTS
TRIPLED
SINCE THE MID-1990'S,



**AND BLACK STUDENT
ENROLLMENT GREW BY
72 PERCENT.**

AND THOSE TRENDS ARE EXPECTED TO CONTINUE THROUGH 2021, WITH BLACK ENROLLMENT
PROJECTED TO GROW BY **25 PERCENT**, HISPANIC STUDENTS PROJECTED TO INCREASE BY
42 PERCENT, AND ONLY A **4 PERCENT** INCREASE IN WHITE STUDENTS FORECASTED.

Lumina Foundation

<https://www.luminafoundation.org/todays-student-citations>



Who are *real* college students?

- Not academically prepared
 - four in 10 high school graduates are required to take remedial courses when they start college.
 - 29% of students at 4-year schools
 - 41% of students at 2-year schools
 - (Ross et al. NCES, August 2012)
- Has financial need
 - Most common reason for leaving college – Cost
 - Males (40%); Females (23%)
- Vague or no career goals



Who is the *ideal* college candidate with a disability?

- Academically prepared
- Strong self advocate
- Clear understanding of accommodations needs
- Financially secure
- Clear career goals
- Strong family support system



Who are the *real* college students?

- Lack self advocacy skills/self-knowledge
- Wanting to establish an identity without disability
- Lack of understanding of accommodation
 - Needs
 - Availability
 - Process
- Fear of stigma
- See: Lightner et al., 2012; Getzel & Thoma, 2008; Denhart, 2008; Salzer et al., 2008



Are we setting college as a goal for youth with disability?



Expectations

- Youth with disabilities are significantly less likely to expect to obtain postsecondary education than youth without disabilities (76% vs. 94%)
 - 50 percent of youth with intellectual disability
 - 60 percent of youth with multiple disabilities
- Parents of youth with disabilities have lower expectations for PSE for their children than parents of youth without disabilities (61% vs. 90%)
 - Across all disability groups
 - Lowest expectations for youth with intellectual disability (32%)

NLTS 2012 - Lipscomb et al. (2017)



Preparing for college

- Youth with disabilities are half as likely as peers without disabilities to take college entrance and placement tests (42% vs. 70%)
- Youth with disabilities are one third as likely as peers without disabilities to participate in dual enrollment (9% vs. 28%)
- Youth with disabilities are less likely than peers without disabilities to report high school staff helped with college application process (54% vs. 60%)

NLTS 2012 - Lipscomb et al. (2017)



The POWER of EXPECTATIONS



Parent expectations about graduating with a diploma (LD), getting a paid job, and/or attending PSE was associated with student outcomes reflecting those expectations.

- Doren, Gau, Lindstrom (2012). The relationship between parent expectations and postschool outcomes of adolescents with disabilities, *Exceptional Children*, 79, 7-23.



Impact on Postsecondary Education

Youth with IDD whose parents expected they would be employed **were 28 times** more likely to have enrolled in postsecondary education after leaving high school than youth whose parents did not expect employment (Papay, 2011).



“College sounds great but you’re not talking about my kid(s). My kids are....”

- Fill in derogatory label of choice





Disability prevents students from
accessing higher education



Student access to
higher education is
impacted by

Family Expectations



Family Expectations
are influenced by professional



All of which are influenced by their past experiences



Which usually is not higher education



So where do students end up?



Sheltered workshops



Living in Poverty



Unemployed



“Parents hopes vanish when confronted with insufficient information and seemingly impassible barriers for their children’s matriculation into college.”

-Martinez, Conroy, Cerreto, 2012



What do you believe?





Do you BELIEVE your
students can go to
college?



Your beliefs and expectations
have a *greater* impact on a
student going to college than
that student's skills or
disability



Its not what students bring to the table....
It is how the table is set that determines outcomes.





"What do you want to bring to the table when you grow up?"





Juan is a fifteen-year-old with an intellectual disability and attention deficit disorder who is in the tenth grade. He struggles with reading and has had detention a few times as he tends not to pay attention in class. He is very good with his hands, and enjoys building things and taking them apart. He doesn't speak up much in class, but during one-on-one he has talked about wishing he could get a good job and help his family.



Ms. LeGrand



- What are Juan's classes in school?
- How will his family learn about college
- How will Juan learn about college?
- What is Juan prepared to do after high school?

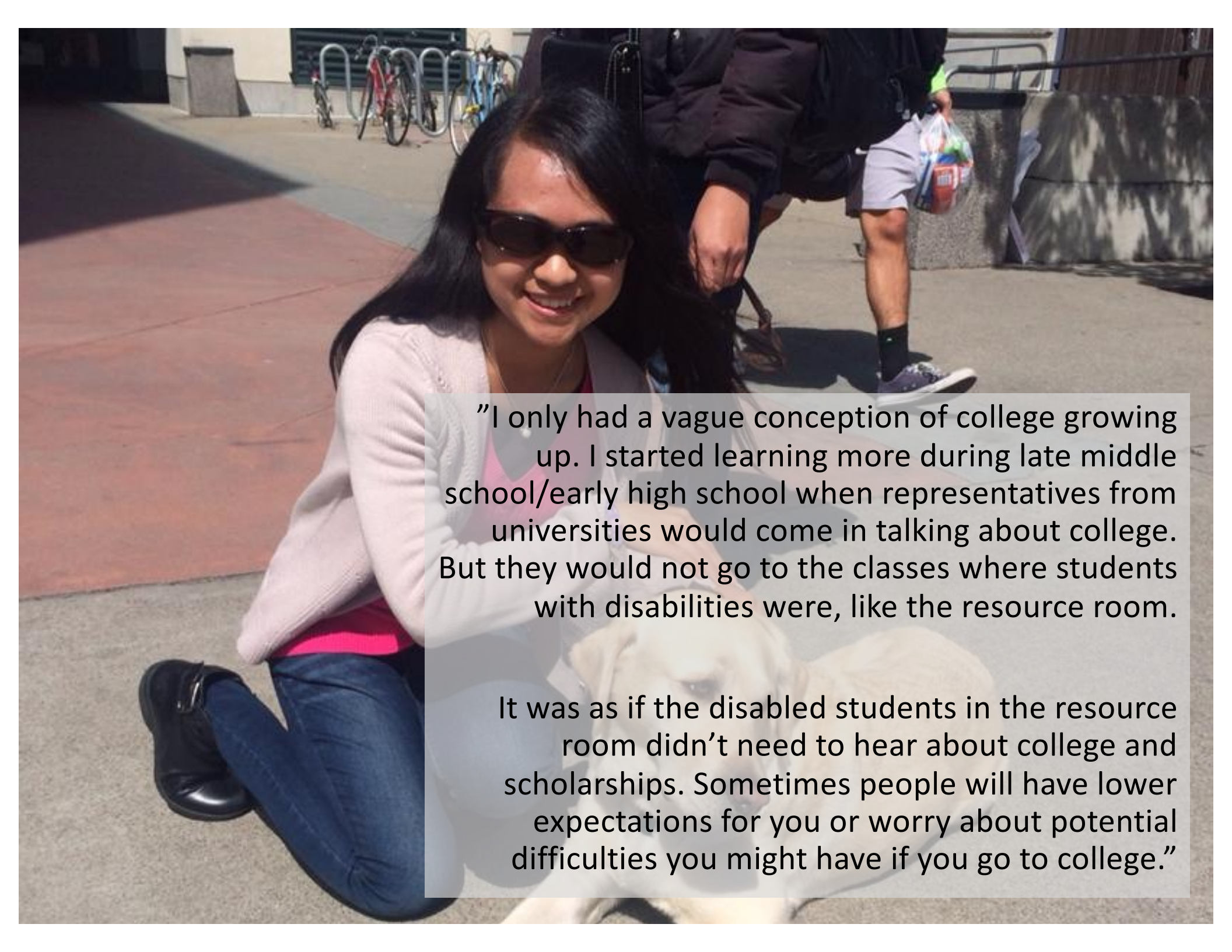
Mr. DiMaria



What messages are students are hearing?

- Students with bad grades can't go to college
- Students with behavior issues can't go to college
- Only wealthy students can go to college
- The only way I can go to college is to go full time or move far away





"I only had a vague conception of college growing up. I started learning more during late middle school/early high school when representatives from universities would come in talking about college. But they would not go to the classes where students with disabilities were, like the resource room.

It was as if the disabled students in the resource room didn't need to hear about college and scholarships. Sometimes people will have lower expectations for you or worry about potential difficulties you might have if you go to college."

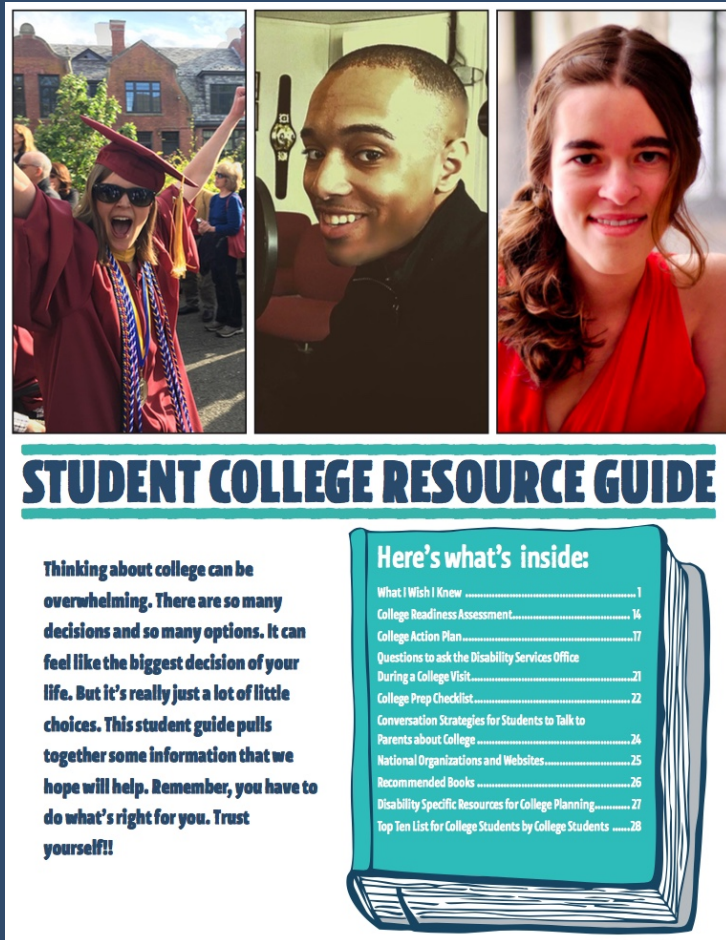


When nondisabled students don't want to go to college and they think it's not for them, they will be pushed, and teachers and counselors will try to convince them to go.

When a disabled student thinks the same way, they are discouraged to even try. [Teachers and counselors] automatically assume because they have a 504 Plan or an IEP that they will not be able to go to college even though they have just as much ability and right to go.



Student Resource Guide



FREE

<https://thinkcollege.net/sites/default/files/files/resources/FinalStudentResourceGuide.pdf>



Our Professional Capacity

- Do we know all current college options?
- Do we share it with parents/students in a meaningful way?
- Are ALL students included in college search and preparation activities?
- Do ALL students with disability get access to the HS counselor?



Who gets what information?

Transition Fair

- Community Rehabilitation Providers
- Employment Supports
- Social service agencies
- Vocational Rehabilitation
- Special education staff
- Transition Staff

College Fair

- Community colleges
- Universities
- Career and technical colleges
- Certificate programs
- For profit universities
- Online colleges
- Financial Aid info Sessions



Ensure College is evident in IEP

Measurable postsecondary goal: Education and training

After graduation, Juan will attend a college or university to pursue education in support of his chosen career path.

IEP goals

Using online resources, Juan will identify a minimum of 3 potential careers that match his interests and strengths, and will be able to state the educational requirements for those careers.

Transition services and activities

- Self-advocacy skills instruction
- Research and visit colleges and universities that have programs in areas that match potential careers
- Attend college fair
- Participate in extra-curricular activities
- Provide information on financial support for college
- Make a plan for paying for college



There is no “right way” to plan for college:

- Checklists are not a replacement for college planning
- Conversations about
 - Timing
 - Priorities
 - Costs
 - Available programs
 - Short and long term goals
- You may be the first one to bring up college as a realistic possibility
- Small steps are better than no steps

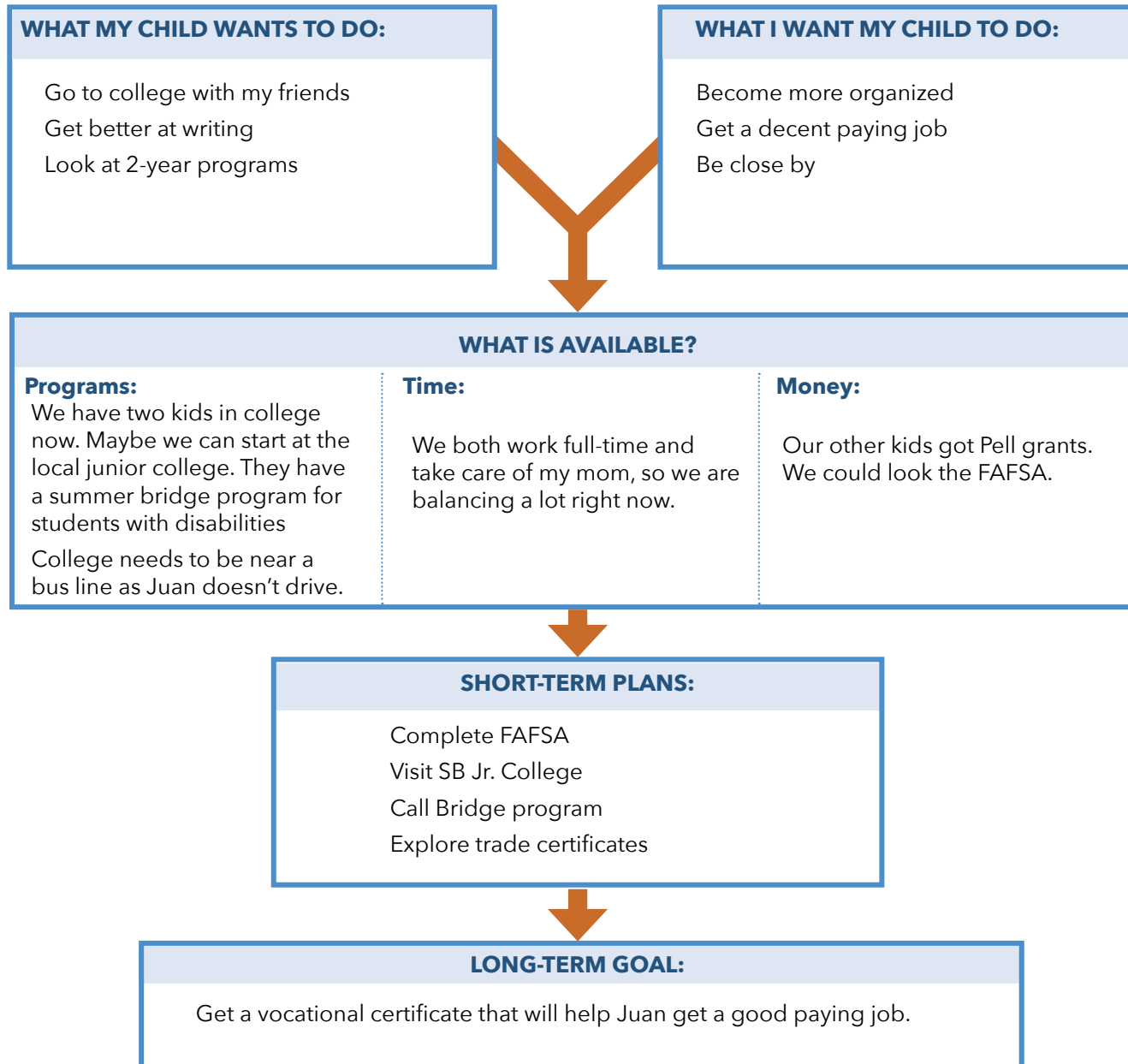


Levels of Learning in College

- Acclimation and exposure-how to navigate adult learning
- Content/Interest-interested in art history, computers, theater and want to know more
- Applied content- I want to become a certified vet tech and need to pass this class



College Mapping Tool



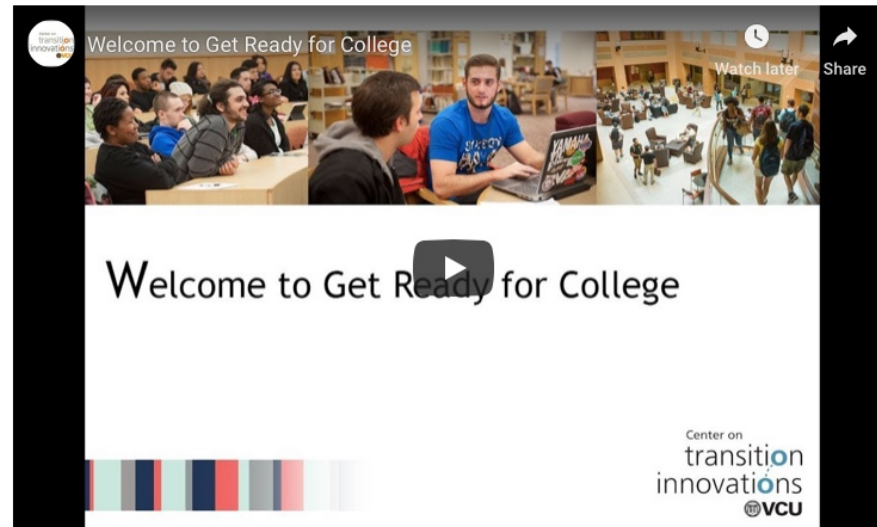
Get Ready for College



GET ready FOR COLLEGE
Center on
transition
innovations
VCU

- ▼ Introduction
 - ▶ Introduction Video
 - ▶ Directions
 - ▶ Portfolio Assignment: Pre-Test
- ▶ Lesson 1: The Differences between High School and College
- ▶ Lesson 2: Postsecondary Education and Training
- ▶ Lesson 3: Knowing Myself
- ▶ Lesson 4: Goal Setting and Action Planning
- ▶ Lesson 5: Applying and Paying for College
- ▶ Lesson 6: Selecting a College
- ▶ Lesson 7: Disability Support Services in College
- ▶ Lesson 8: Exploring Technology
- ▶ Conclusion

Introduction Video



- <https://centerontransition.org/training/getready.cfm>

Free series of online lessons, each focusing on a different aspect in the college preparation, selection, and disability services process



The Ultimate College Outcomes

- Being a consumer of your education instead of a passive recipient
- Viewing the acquisition of knowledge as a desirable experience
- Connecting learning to real outcomes





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